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1929, The HSRA

After the Naujawan Bharat Sabha, it was an easy step two years later for Bhagat Singh to inaugurate the mutinous HSRA, which was set up in 1929, principally by Chandrashekhar Azad and Bhagat Singh. He was 21 years old then. Though on the site of the fort of Ferozeshah Kotla, a plaque today commemorates the establishment of the HSRA with the names of Bhagat Singh, Sukhdev and Rajguru, few realize that it was the establishment on that cold night in September 1928, on the outskirts of Delhi in the dilapidated ruins of a medieval fort, of the Hindustan Socialist Republican Association ('HRSA') that completed the transformation that Bhagat Singh was seeking in the nature of the revolutionary struggle that had to be waged against colonial rule.

The HRA was henceforth to be the HSRA, with 'socialism' being given an added emphasis. The central committee of the HSRA comprised such stalwarts as Sukhdev, an ardent adherent of communist philosophy. It also included the journalist Vijay Kumar Sinha (also known as 'Bejoy'). Since the genesis of the movement was traceable to India's three provinces of Punjab, the United Provinces (now Uttar Pradesh) and Bihar, there were to be two representatives from each of these provinces in the central committee. The HSRA itself was to comprise two parts. These were to be the ideological and the military wings. Bhagat Singh took charge of the ideological wing. The task of managing the HSRA's 'military' operations was handed over to such hardened activists as Shiv Verma and Chandrashekhar Azad (who had participated in the Kakori train robbery a year earlier in 1925). The fact that Bhagat Singh later participated in the